

FOR PRINCIPALS & SUPERINTENDENTS · 3-MINUTE READ

AI for Workload: Winning Back an Hour a Week

A 45–60 minute, self-facilitated session: every teacher audits their real week, templates their two worst repeating tasks, and writes a protected list of the work that stays human. Run by your own coach; no consultant required.

THE STANCE, AND YOUR STAFF ANSWER

Hand the repetitive to the tool; keep the relational on purpose. Recovered hours go to teaching, planning, or leaving on time, never to new busywork.

Why this matters now

K-12 reports the highest burnout of any U.S. industry: 44% of workers and 52% of teachers "always or very often" burned out (Gallup, 2022), inside a ~54-hour week where less than half is teaching (Merrimack/EdWeek, 2022). Teachers using AI weekly report ~5.9 hours a week back, about six weeks a year (Gallup, 2025). This session locates each teacher's share of those hours, and writes down what the hours are for.

What your staff will be able to do afterward

- Audit a week with the two-question sort: needs my kids? does it repeat?
- Template recurring tasks: build once with placeholders, test twice, reuse forever
- Batch same-kind tasks and share templates in the staff library
- Keep a written protected list: the relational work no tool touches
- Hold the review rule so "AI drafts it" never drifts into "AI decides it"
- Keep the privacy rule: no student information in public tools, at any workload

Research base in brief

Burnout: Gallup Panel Workforce Study (2022) · Teacher workweek: Merrimack College & EdWeek Research Center (2022) · Time savings: Gallup & Walton Family Foundation (2025) · Adoption: RAND RR-A4180-1 (2025) · PD design: Darling-Hammond et al., Learning Policy Institute (2017). Full APA citations ship in the kit's References file.

Where it fits

Kit 7 of 8 in **Track A: AI Foundations**. Ships with a 30-day plan (template clinic, library sprint, and an honest reckoning on where the hours went) and an exit ticket that doubles as PD documentation. Kit 8, the capstone, is next.

The leadership move that makes it real: say publicly that recovered hours will not be refilled with new initiatives. It costs nothing, and it's the highest-trust sentence available to a school leader this month.